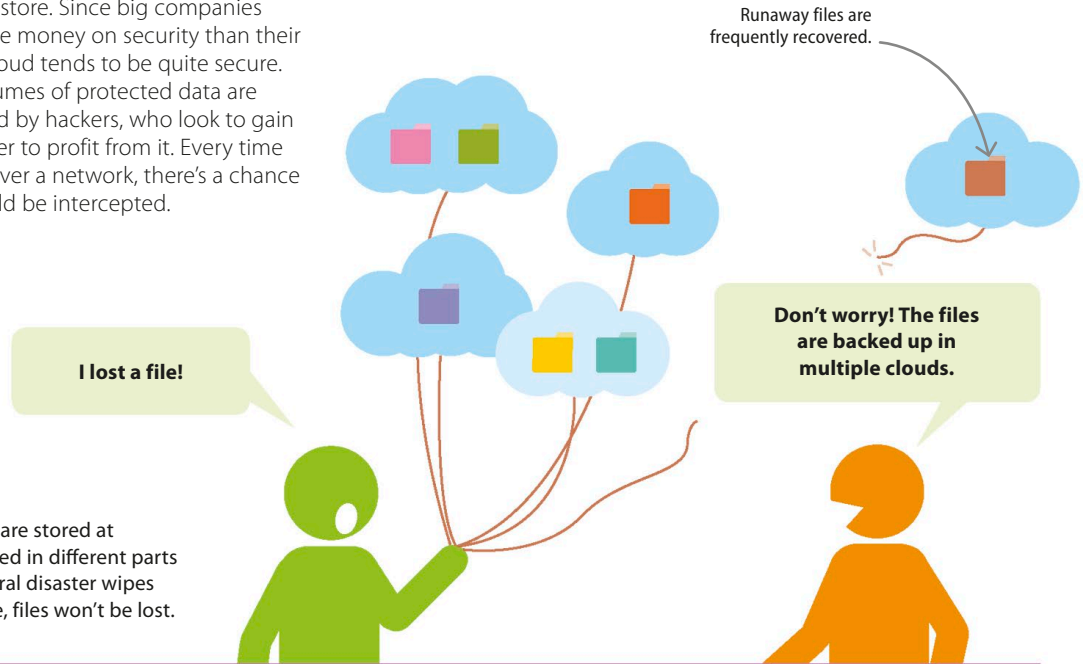


How safe are your files?

Cloud storage providers are responsible for maintaining backups of the files they store. Since big companies can generally spend more money on security than their customers, data in the cloud tends to be quite secure. However, such huge volumes of protected data are more likely to be targeted by hackers, who look to gain access to the data in order to profit from it. Every time users synchronize a file over a network, there's a chance that the information could be intercepted.



▷ Multiple data centres

Copies of files in the cloud are stored at multiple data centres located in different parts of the world. Even if a natural disaster wipes out a particular data centre, files won't be lost.

Other cloud services

Apart from storage, services such as software rental and access to specialized hardware can also be provided on demand through the internet. These services help users cut costs through resource sharing. Unlike traditional software, cloud-based programs can be used on any type of operating system. In addition, multiple people can access the same file, which makes it easy to collaborate.



◁ Resource sharing

For complex, CPU-intensive calculations, users can temporarily rent someone else's system and access it through the internet. Renting instead of buying can be great for small companies.

IN DEPTH

Pros and cons

Cloud services are useful, but they're not always the right choice for an individual or a company.

Pros

- If a device is lost, damaged, or stolen, the files or programs are still safe.
- Files can be accessed from anywhere.
- There are no portability issues when the operating system is changed.

Cons

- Cloud services need a fast internet connection.
- There is dependency on the cloud service provider for security and backup.
- Sending information over a network always carries risks, even when precautions such as encryption are taken.